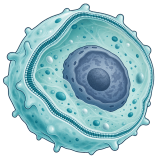
From a disease question to a candidate decision

1 Disease and mechanism



Decision

Causal relevance

- Correlation as mechanism

2 Target identification

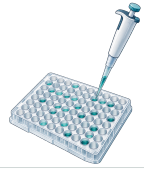


Decision

Actionable entity

- Identity collapse

3 Target validation

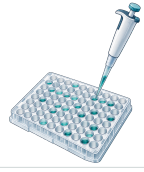


Decision

Phenotype change

- Evidence reuse

4 Assay and data strategy

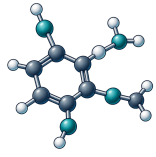


Decision

Optimisation quantity

- Pooled endpoints

5 Hit discovery

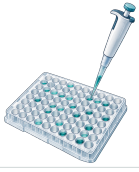


Decision

Worth confirming?

- Retrospective as prospective

6 Hit confirmation

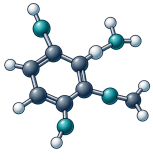


Decision

Attributable activity

- Artefact as binding

7 Hit-to-lead

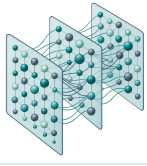


Decision

Series headroom

- Endpoint loss

8 Lead optimisation



Decision

Acceptable trade-off

- Scalar hides liability

9 Candidate nomination



Decision

Package coherence

- Confidence as experiment

Numbers and arrows give stage order. Warm diamond labels identify frequent failures.

AI-generated conceptual illustrations. Native labels and relationships.